

Government accountability demo

UpSight business assessment and team decision brief | 8 October 2026 | Internal

Recommendation: build one bounded demo and publish it. Treat this as a product demonstration and sales asset. Its value is showing how public feedback can be traced into policy choices and government follow-through. Immediate funding is optional; a reusable demonstration is the required return.

What the Berkeley proposal tells us

The agenda asks the next governor to establish civic leadership, institutions, research, surveys and grantmaking. It would expand the ecosystem in which its authors operate. That is a reasonable commercial reading; it does not establish improper motives or a budget available to UpSight. The proposal is a market signal, not a customer order. [1]

It does explicitly call for accountability to participant input and agency assessments. The opening for UpSight is to make that principle concrete: which concerns informed which decisions, what was declined and why, who is responsible, and what evidence shows delivery. Build that demonstration rather than a general critique of the authors. [1]

The real business opportunity

A buyer should see the demo and think: **I want my stakeholder feedback connected to our decisions this clearly.** That applies to engagement consultants, cities, foundations, membership organizations and businesses. Consultants are the most practical first sales hypothesis: they can use the output in a client deliverable without waiting for a new statewide institution.

Value	Assessment
Product proof	Strong if users can inspect source evidence and decision links. Another AI theme summary has little distinction.
Public debate	Useful if it asks a concrete question: what should government publish after asking residents for input?
Sales opener	Promising across sectors. Show a real case, then offer the same workflow on the prospect's own feedback.
Near term revenue	Unproven. No identified buyer, approved budget or purchasing commitment.
Strategic cost	Worth a small sprint. Poor use of time if it requires a separate civic product or ongoing unpaid monitoring.

What we would build

A narrow public case with a reusable sales demonstration

Use a real feedback and response pair

Use the Engaged California LA wildfire case as the first candidate. The state publishes downloadable comments, AI-assisted grouping, policy options, community rankings and reported government responses. That gives us both input and a response to inspect. Berkeley provides the debate context; this dataset provides the demonstration. [2, 3]

The earlier assessment overstates the gap: the 19 items were policy options, not 19 completed actions, and the state already reports follow-through. Our demo must show what additional traceability UpSight provides. Related subject matter alone does not prove feedback caused a policy or that an announced action was completed. [3]

Minimum publishable scope

One public page and a three-minute walkthrough. Import the available comments into the existing product. Show themes with source comments, differing views and unmapped input. Deep-review three priority issues; do not attempt to audit the entire recovery effort.

For each issue, show **input → policy response → responsible body → commitment or deadline → delivery evidence**. Link sources at every step. Label each connection as an official documented link, an analyst-inferred relationship, or no link found. Separate announced, funded, underway and completed status. Use "not documented in reviewed sources" when the record is incomplete.

Allow viewers to inspect the evidence and challenge a mapping. Include a simple prompt for debate: **When government asks for your input, what should it owe you in return?** Close with a sales invitation to map the viewer's own stakeholder feedback. Publish under UpSight with clear independent attribution.

Effort and team decision

Proposed cap: 40 total team hours over two weeks. Allocate 6 hours to source and product-fit checks, 18 to import and mapping, 10 to human review, and 6 to publication and the walkthrough. Assign one product owner, one builder and one evidence reviewer; people can share roles. These are planning estimates, not commitments.

After the first 6 hours, proceed only if the current product can demonstrate the chain credibly. If it requires substantial new infrastructure, reduce scope or stop. Prioritize reusable evidence links and decision records. Defer custom civic dashboards, new collection tools and ongoing status monitoring.

What counts as success

At publication: a defensible case, a clear walkthrough and an asset the team can use in sales without explanation from Rick. Revenue is not required for this outcome.

Within 30 days: use it in five targeted conversations with consultants or stakeholder-facing organizations. Look for requests to map their own data; quote a scoped paid pilot when appropriate. Views and praise indicate reach, not demand. If it earns no such requests, retain the demo and stop further civic-specific investment.

Team decision: approve the effort cap, confirm which parts already work, assign owners and choose a publish date. Confidence is moderate on demo value; low on near-term revenue until prospects respond.

Evidence checked 8 October 2026. Sources: [1] UC Berkeley Possibility Lab, Civic Engagement Agenda, possibilitylab.berkeley.edu/civic-engagement-agenda/ [2] Engaged California, Agenda setting data insights, engaged.ca.gov/lafires-recovery/agenda-setting-data-insights/ [3] Engaged California, LA recovery action plan, engaged.ca.gov/lafires-recovery/action-plan/. Attached Claude assessment reviewed; its procurement and funding claims are not relied on here.